

# PROPERTIES OF TRIANGLES, HEIGHTS AND DISTANCES

## SYNOPSIS AND FORMULAE

### Properties of Triangle

In a  $\triangle ABC$ , if  $a, b, c$  are its sides and  $A, B$  and  $C$  are its angles then,

#### (i) Sine Rule

$$\frac{a}{\sin A} = \frac{b}{\sin B} = \frac{c}{\sin C} = 2R$$

Where,

$R$  = Circum radius

The ratio of sides of triangle is equal to respective ratio of sines of angles i.e.,

$$a : b : c = \sin A : \sin B : \sin C.$$

#### (ii) Cosine Rule (or) Law of Cosines

In  $\triangle ABC$ ,

$$b^2 = c^2 + a^2 - 2ca \cos B$$

$$c^2 = a^2 + b^2 - 2ab \cos C$$

$$a^2 = b^2 + c^2 - 2bc \cos A$$

#### (iii) Deductions from Cosine Rule

$$\begin{aligned} + \cos A &= \frac{b^2 + c^2 - a^2}{2bc}, \cos B = \frac{c^2 + a^2 - b^2}{2ac}, \cos C \\ &= \frac{a^2 + b^2 - c^2}{2ab} \end{aligned}$$

$$+ a^2 + b^2 + c^2 = 2ab \cos C + 2bc \cos A + 2ca \cos B$$

#### (iv) Projection Rule

In  $\triangle ABC$ ,

$$a = b \cos C + c \cos B$$

$$b = c \cos A + a \cos C$$

$$c = a \cos B + b \cos A$$

#### (v) Deductions from Projection Rule

$$2s = a + b + c$$

$$= (b+c) \cos A + (c+a) \cos B + (a+b) \cos C$$

$$2s = a + b + c$$

$$= a(\cos B + \cos C) + b(\cos C + \cos A) + c(\cos A + \cos B)$$

#### (vi) Napier Analogy (or) Tangent Rule

In  $\triangle ABC$ ,

$$\tan\left(\frac{B-C}{2}\right) = \frac{b-c}{b+c} \cot \frac{A}{2}$$

$$\tan\left(\frac{C-A}{2}\right) = \frac{c-a}{c+a} \cot \frac{B}{2}$$

$$\tan\left(\frac{A-B}{2}\right) = \frac{a-b}{a+b} \cot \frac{C}{2}$$

#### (vii) Deductions from Tangent Rule

$$\frac{b-c}{b+c} = \tan\left(\frac{B-C}{2}\right) \tan \frac{A}{2}$$

$$\frac{a-b}{a+b} = \tan\left(\frac{A-B}{2}\right) \tan \frac{C}{2}$$

$$\frac{c-a}{c+a} = \tan\left(\frac{C-A}{2}\right) \tan\left(\frac{B}{2}\right)$$

+ If  $a, b, c$  are the sides of  $\triangle$  and semiperimeter is

$$s = \frac{a+b+c}{2}, \text{ then area of a triangle is given}$$

by,

$$\Delta = \frac{1}{2} bc \sin A = \frac{1}{2} ca \sin B = \frac{1}{2} ab \sin C$$

$$\Delta = 2R^2 \sin A \sin B \sin C$$

$$\Delta = \sqrt{s(s-a)(s-b)(s-c)}$$

$$\Delta = \frac{abc}{4R}$$

#### + (Half Angle Formulae of Triangle)

$$(i) \sin \frac{A}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{(s-b)(s-c)}{bc}}, \sin \frac{B}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{(s-a)(s-c)}{ac}},$$

$$\sin \frac{C}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{(s-a)(s-b)}{ab}}$$

$$(ii) \cos \frac{A}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{s(s-a)}{bc}}, \cos \frac{B}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{s(s-b)}{ac}},$$

$$\cos \frac{C}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{s(s-c)}{ab}}$$

$$(iii) \tan \frac{A}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{(s-b)(s-c)}{s(s-a)}}, \tan \frac{B}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{(s-a)(s-c)}{s(s-b)}},$$

$$\tan \frac{C}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{(s-b)(s-a)}{s(s-c)}}$$

# (MATHEMATICS)

## Deduction from $\frac{1}{2}$ Angle Formulae

$$\begin{aligned}
 + \sin A &= 2 \sin \frac{A}{2} \cos \frac{A}{2} = \frac{2\Delta}{bc} \\
 + \sin B &= 2 \sin \frac{B}{2} \cos \frac{B}{2} = \frac{2\Delta}{ca} \\
 + \sin C &= 2 \sin \frac{C}{2} \cos \frac{C}{2} = \frac{2\Delta}{ab} \\
 + \tan\left(\frac{A}{2}\right) &= \frac{(s-b)(s-c)}{\Delta} = \frac{\Delta}{s(s-a)} = \frac{1}{\cot\left(\frac{A}{2}\right)} \\
 + \tan\left(\frac{B}{2}\right) &= \frac{(s-a)(s-c)}{\Delta} = \frac{\Delta}{s(s-b)} = \frac{1}{\cot\left(\frac{B}{2}\right)} \\
 + \tan\left(\frac{C}{2}\right) &= \frac{(s-a)(s-b)}{\Delta} = \frac{\Delta}{s(s-c)} = \frac{1}{\cot\left(\frac{C}{2}\right)}
 \end{aligned}$$

## From Sine Rule in a Triangle,

$$\begin{aligned}
 + \frac{a+b}{c} &= \frac{\cos\left(\frac{A-B}{2}\right)}{\sin\left(\frac{C}{2}\right)}, \quad \frac{a-b}{c} = \frac{\sin\left(\frac{A-B}{2}\right)}{\cos\left(\frac{C}{2}\right)} \\
 + \frac{b+c}{a} &= \frac{\cos\left(\frac{B-C}{2}\right)}{\sin\left(\frac{A}{2}\right)}, \quad \frac{b-c}{a} = \frac{\sin\left(\frac{B-C}{2}\right)}{\cos\left(\frac{A}{2}\right)} \\
 + \frac{c+a}{b} &= \frac{\cos\left(\frac{C-A}{2}\right)}{\sin\left(\frac{B}{2}\right)}, \quad \frac{c-a}{b} = \frac{\sin\left(\frac{C-A}{2}\right)}{\cos\left(\frac{B}{2}\right)}
 \end{aligned}$$

+ If  $a, b, c$  are in A.P., then  $\cot \frac{A}{2}, \cot \frac{B}{2}, \cot \frac{C}{2}$  are in A.P.

+ If  $a, b, c$  are in H.P., then  $\sin^2 \frac{A}{2}, \sin^2 \frac{B}{2}, \sin^2 \frac{C}{2}$  are in H.P.

+ In a  $\Delta$  if  $\angle A = 60^\circ$ , then

$$\begin{aligned}
 (i) \quad \frac{1}{a+b} + \frac{1}{a+c} &= \frac{3}{a+b+c} \\
 (ii) \quad (a+b+c)(b+c-a) &= 3bc \\
 (iii) \quad \frac{c}{a+b} + \frac{b}{a+c} &= 1
 \end{aligned}$$

The respective results follow for  $\angle B = 60^\circ$  and  $\angle C = 60^\circ$ .

## Incircle and Excircle

+ The circle which touches all three sides of a triangle internally is referred as incircle or inscribed.

+ The centre (I) and radius (r) of an incircle is referred as in centre and inradius respectively. In a triangle ABC,

$$\begin{aligned}
 + \tan \frac{A}{2} \tan \frac{B}{2} &= \frac{s-c}{s} \\
 \tan \frac{C}{2} \tan \frac{A}{2} &= \frac{s-b}{s} \\
 \tan \frac{B}{2} \tan \frac{C}{2} &= \frac{s-a}{s}
 \end{aligned}$$

$$(i) \Delta = rs$$

$$(ii) r = (s-a) \tan \frac{A}{2} = (s-b) \tan \frac{B}{2} = (s-c) \tan \frac{C}{2}$$

$$(iii) r = \frac{a}{\cot \frac{B}{2} + \cot \frac{C}{2}} = \frac{b}{\cot \frac{C}{2} + \cot \frac{A}{2}} = \frac{c}{\cot \frac{A}{2} + \cot \frac{B}{2}}$$

$$(iv) r = 4R \sin \frac{A}{2} \sin \frac{B}{2} \sin \frac{C}{2}$$

+ The circle that touches the sides AB externally and the side BC internally in as excircle opposite to angle A.

+ The radius and centre of circle opposite angle A are called exradius and excentre denoted by  $r_1$  and  $I_1$  respectively. Similarly  $r_2, r_3$  and  $I_2, I_3$  are defined.

$$(i) r_1 = \frac{\Delta}{s-a}, r_2 = \frac{\Delta}{s-b}, r_3 = \frac{\Delta}{s-c}$$

$$(ii) r_1 = s \tan \frac{A}{2} = (s-c) \cot \frac{B}{2} = (s-b) \cot \frac{C}{2}$$

$$(iii) r_1 = \frac{a}{\tan \frac{B}{2} + \tan \frac{C}{2}}$$

$$r_2 = \frac{b}{\tan \frac{C}{2} + \tan \frac{A}{2}}$$

$$r_3 = \frac{c}{\tan \frac{A}{2} + \tan \frac{B}{2}}$$

$$(iv) r_1 = 4R \sin \frac{A}{2} \cos \frac{B}{2} \cos \frac{C}{2}$$

$$r_2 = 4R \cos \frac{A}{2} \sin \frac{B}{2} \cos \frac{C}{2}$$

$$r_3 = 4R \cos \frac{A}{2} \cos \frac{B}{2} \sin \frac{C}{2}$$

+ If in a triangle  $r_1, r_2, r_3$  are the exradii then

$$\frac{1}{r_1} + \frac{1}{r_2} + \frac{1}{r_3} = \frac{1}{r}$$

$$r r_1 r_2 r_3 = \Delta^2$$

$$\frac{1}{r^2} + \frac{1}{r_1^2} + \frac{1}{r_2^2} + \frac{1}{r_3^2} = \frac{a^2 + b^2 + c^2}{\Delta^2}$$

+ If  $a, b, c$  are in A.P., if and only if  $r_1, r_2, r_3$  are in H.P.

$$+ r + r_3 + r_2 - r_1 = 4R \cos A$$

$$+ r + r_3 + r_1 - r_2 = 4R \cos B$$

$$+ r + r_1 + r_2 - r_3 = 4R \cos C$$

+ If  $p_1, p_2, p_3$  are altitudes drawn from the vertices of A, B, C to opposite sides of a triangle!

$$(i) \frac{1}{p_1} + \frac{1}{p_2} + \frac{1}{p_3} = \frac{1}{r}$$

$$(ii) \frac{1}{p_2} + \frac{1}{p_3} - \frac{1}{p_1} = \frac{1}{r_1}$$

$$(iii) p_1 p_2 p_3 = \frac{(abc)^2}{8R^3} = \frac{8\Delta^3}{abc}$$

$$(iv) \frac{1}{p_1^2} + \frac{1}{p_2^2} + \frac{1}{p_3^2} = \frac{\cot A + \cot B + \cot C}{\Delta}$$